

UX / UI CASE STUDY

ThrottleSync

Group Riding Reinvented

Smarter Rides. Stronger Brotherhood.

Navigation + Team Sync + Safety — All in One Ride System

Role	Tool	Timeline	Type
UI/UX Designer	Figma	4 Weeks	Self-Initiated

SECTION 01

Project Introduction

ThrottleSync is a self-initiated UX concept built for tourers and long-distance group riders. It tackles a real-world gap: enabling **safe, coordinated, and enjoyable group rides** while fully respecting individual riding styles and pace.

10+

Riders
Interviewed

3

Competitors
Analysed

9

Case Study
Sections

4 wk

Design
Timeline

The Problem Space

- Riders have different speeds — some lead, some cruise mid-pack, others lag behind
- Traditional solutions break ride discipline, causing stress for both slow and fast riders
- Communication is fragmented: maps, Bluetooth intercoms, calls & music = constant distraction
- No app integrates navigation, communication, safety, and coordination in one place

"How might we design a hands-free, smart, and reliable riding assistant that lets every rider maintain their pace, keeps the group connected, and ensures safety throughout the journey?"

Design Goals

Goal	Description
Real-time group navigation & tracking	Live sync of all rider positions on a shared map
Smart journey alerts	Breaks, fuel, regrouping — contextually triggered
Integrated music, calls & voice intercom	Single hands-free dashboard, zero phone handling
Individual pace respect	No forced grouping; every rider owns their speed
Safety-first experience	Crash detection, SOS, live tracking always on

My Role & Scope

Role	Scope	Tools	Timeline
UI/UX Designer (End-to-End Concept)	Research · UX Strategy Wireframing · Interaction Design UI Concept	Figma	4 Weeks Self-Initiated

SECTION 02

User Research & Insights

Research centred on understanding rider behaviour, communication pain points, navigation challenges, and safety needs across diverse riding contexts.

User Interviews	Community Analysis	Competitive Audit
10 riders from weekend groups & touring clubs	Reddit, xBhp, RE Riders, FB Clubs	RideLink, WolfPack, EatSleepRIDE

Key Research Insights

Insight	Explanation	Opportunity
Varied Riding Styles	Each rider rides at their own pace; not everyone wants to lead	Allow flexible pacing while keeping the group synced
Fragmented Communication	Switching between maps, calls & music is dangerous while riding	Integrate calls, music & navigation in a single dashboard
Safety is Paramount	Riders worry about crashes, getting lost, or unexpected delays	Proactive SOS alerts & emergency notifications
Coordination is Hard	Riders get separated; regrouping is confusing and stressful	Smart alerts: break points, fuel stops & city reminders
Journey Experience Matters	Riders want to enjoy scenery with minimal app interaction	Visual alerts, on-map cues, subtle contextual reminders

User Persona

ROHANLong-Distance Tourer / Mid-Pack Cruiser	
Goals ✓ Stay connected with friends in the group ✓ Avoid distractions while riding ✓ Maintain personal pace without feeling left behind Frustrations ✗ Group rides feel stressful when riders fall behind ✗ Frequently checks phone / intercom for instructions ✗ No easy way to know where teammates are in real time	Design Implication ThrottleSync should automate communication and coordination, keeping riders informed without requiring constant attention or screen interaction. Age: 28 Ride Type: Long-distance touring

User Journey Map — Pain Points & Opportunities

Stage	Current Reality	Pain Points	ThrottleSync Solution
Pre-Ride Planning	WhatsApp discussion, Google Maps sharing	Confusing; missing details; planning errors	One-click ride setup, auto-sync group route
Ride Start	Riders take positions, some lag, some lead	Separation; miscommunication	Real-time map tracking; flexible pacing
Mid-Ride	Intercom or phone calls	Distracting, unsafe, delayed responses	Voice alerts + push-to-ride intercom + safety notifis
Breaks / Fuel	Riders stop randomly along route	Coordination chaos; missed stops	Smart reminders for fuel, rest & regrouping
End of Ride	Riders reconnect after the ride	Stress; missed coordination	Ride summary, alerts & safety confirmation

Key Research Takeaways

- 01** Safety + Comfort are Non-Negotiable — riders want to feel secure and stress-free at all times
- 02** Coordination Without Restriction — every rider must maintain their own pace without breaking group flow
- 03** Seamless Communication — voice alerts and minimal interaction reduce distractions on the road
- 04** Smart Journey Awareness — auto-reminders and notifications enhance experience without interrupting the ride

SECTION 03

Competitor Analysis & Opportunity Mapping

Three leading group-riding apps were audited to identify gaps and define where ThrottleSync delivers unique value.

RideLink	GPS tracking & ride logging
+ Basic group tracking, safety alerts	– No integrated communication or infotainment; limited group coordination
WolfPack	Group navigation & coordination
+ Live group location, route sharing	– No music/call integration; minimal safety alerts; limited reminders
EatSleepRIDE	GPS + Safety-focused
+ Crash detection, ride logging	– No group communication; lacks smart journey alerts or pace management

Competitive Feature Matrix

Feature	RideLink	WolfPack	ESR	ThrottleSync
Live Group Location	Yes	Yes	No	Yes — Full
Route Sync	No	Yes	No	Yes — Auto
Voice / Intercom Communication	No	No	No	Yes — Push-to-Ride
Music & Call Integration	No	No	No	Yes — Hands-free
Safety Alerts (SOS, Crash)	Yes	No	Yes	Yes — Crash + SOS
On-Map Smart Reminders	No	No	No	Yes — Fuel/Break/City
Individual Pace Respect	No	No	No	Yes — Flexible Sync
Offline / Low-Data Support	No	No	No	Yes — Offline Maps

Opportunity Mapping

Rider Need	Current Gap	ThrottleSync Solution
Stay connected without distraction	Apps separate calls, maps, and music	Unified dashboard + hands-free voice communication
Flexible group coordination	Riders forced to keep pace or get lost	Sync routes while fully respecting individual speed
Reliable safety net	Limited emergency tracking; no auto detection	Location tracking + automatic crash + SOS broadcast
Smart journey awareness	No automated reminders along route	Auto city / fuel / break push notifications
Enjoyable, immersive ride	Multiple apps = fragmented experience	Streamlined minimal-interaction dashboard

Opportunity Heatmap — Where ThrottleSync Wins

Quadrant	Features
High Value / High Diff. (Priority)	Voice intercom • Flexible pacing • Smart reminders • Offline maps
High Value / Low Diff.	Group map tracking • SOS crash alerts
Low Priority	Basic route logging (already in competitors; table-stakes only)

SECTION 04

Product Strategy & Feature Definition

"ThrottleSync empowers riders to ride together safely, stay connected effortlessly, and enjoy every journey — without compromising individual freedom."

Strategic Pillars

Safety First	Always keep riders informed and secure — alerts, tracking, SOS are always on
Freedom Within Coordination	Allow individual pace; the app ensures group integrity behind the scenes
Intuitive Rider-Friendly UX	Minimal interaction during rides; glanceability is the primary design standard
Community-Oriented Design	Enhances connection and trust — the ride experience extends beyond the road

Core Features of ThrottleSync

Feature	Description	UX Rationale
Live Group Map Sync	Real-time position tracking of all riders	Reduces stress, prevents separation, enables flexible pacing
Push-to-Ride Intercom	Voice communication within the group	Minimal distraction; enhances rider-to-rider connection
Music & Call Integration	Android Auto-style hands-free control	Avoids phone handling; improves safety and focus
On-Map Smart Reminders	Fuel, break, city, and regroup alerts	Reduces planning stress; keeps journey organised automatically
Individual Pace Respect	Riders maintain personal speed within sync	Preserves freedom; reduces anxiety; ensures group cohesion
Crash & SOS Alerts	Auto crash detection + emergency broadcast	Prioritises safety; fosters trust and peace of mind
Journey Summary	Post-ride recap: route, duration, incidents	Encourages reflection, community sharing, and improvement

Feature Prioritisation

Priority	Features
Must-Have	Live Map Sync • Intercom • Crash / SOS Alerts • Pace Respect
Nice-to-Have	Smart Reminders • Music & Call Integration • Journey Summary
Future Vision	Post-Ride Gamification • AI Route Suggestions • Ride Challenges

SECTION 05

Information Architecture & User Flow

ThrottleSync is structured around three core modules that mirror the natural stages of a group ride: preparation, the ride itself, and post-ride debrief.

ThrottleSync App		
Ride Hub	Communication Center	Smart Journey Mgmt
Live Map Rider Positions ETA & Distance Pace Indicators	Push-to-Ride Intercom Music & Call Controls Alerts & Notifications	Break / Fuel Alerts City Reminders Crash & SOS Post-Ride Summary

End-to-End User Flow

	Stage	What Happens
1	Pre-Ride Setup	Create/join group → sync route auto → configure smart reminder distances
2	Live Map + Sync	Dashboard shows live rider positions, ETAs, and pace indicators
3	Intercom & Music	Hands-free voice comms and media controls — swipe gesture or voice command
4	Smart Alerts	Contextual fuel/break/city notifications triggered automatically
5	Crash / SOS	Auto crash detection active; manual SOS broadcasts to full group + contacts
6	Post-Ride Summary	Route stats, group recap, incident log, badges, optional sharing

SECTION 06

Wireframes & UI Design Direction

Starting from lo-fi sketches to explore core interactions, the design evolved through iterative Figma refinements into a hi-fi system guided by three core principles: **Bold**, **Adventurous**, and **Safe**.

Core Screens & Key Design Decisions

Screen	Key Design Decisions	UX Rationale
Ride Hub / Dashboard	Full-width map, minimal overlays, rider icons + ETA only	Clarity at speed; no visual clutter
Communication Center	Floating voice button, swipe gestures, contextual alerts	Eyes-free activation; no unnecessary taps
Smart Journey Mgmt	Pop-up reminders (auto-dismiss), colour-coded severity	Non-blocking; critical info always visible
Crash / SOS Screen	Full-screen takeover, large tap target, voice confirmation	Cannot be missed at 80+ km/h
Post-Ride Summary	Hierarchy-led layout, colour-coded stats, share CTA	CTA recall; rewards community sharing

Colour Palette

Swatch	Hex	Name	Usage
	#1A2A40	Midnight Blue	Primary — Maps, backgrounds, nav bars
	#FF6600	Highway Orange	Accent — Ride indicators, highlights, CTAs
	#FF3B30	Alert Red	Danger — Crash / SOS / urgent warnings
	#34C759	Safe Green	Confirmation — Safe state, reminders, info
	#F5F7FA	Light BG	Surface — Cards, panels, secondary backgrounds

Typography & Interaction Guidelines

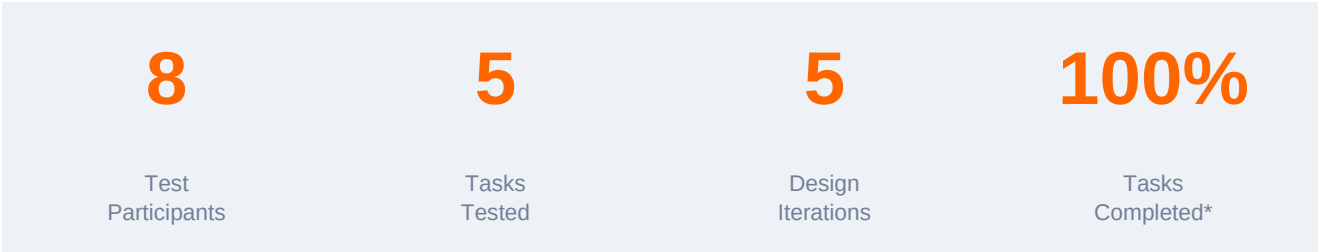
Element	Choice	Rationale
Typeface	Bold Sans-Serif	Maximum legibility at riding speeds
Touch Targets	44px+ minimum	Safe finger-tap accuracy with riding gloves
Map Overlays	Minimal: rider icons + ETA only	Reduce cognitive load; keep eyes on road
Alert Style	Full-screen takeover	Cannot be overlooked at 80 km/h
Intercom	Swipe gesture + visual hint	Eyes-free, glove-friendly activation

Contrast	WCAG AA minimum outdoors	Readable under direct sunlight conditions
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SECTION 07

Prototype & Usability Testing

A clickable Figma prototype was developed covering all three core modules. **8 riders** from touring clubs and weekend groups participated in scenario-based remote usability walkthroughs.



*After final iteration round

Tasks Tested

- Join a group and sync the ride route
- Use live map to locate all rider positions
- Send and receive a push-to-ride intercom message
- Respond to a fuel or break reminder notification
- Trigger and dismiss a crash / SOS alert

Key Findings & Design Iterations

Finding	Observation	Design Solution	Outcome
Map clutter	Too much detail on screen	Simplified overlays; toggle layers	Faster orientation
Intercom confusion	Swipe gesture not intuitive	Added onboarding hint + visual cue	Zero errors post-change
Alert timing off	Reminders felt too early or late	Customisable reminder distance settings	Higher trust in alerts
Screen distraction	Riders looked at map too frequently	Voice prompts added for key events	Eyes-on-road rate improved
Post-ride data unclear	Some metrics were confusing	Regrouped labels, primary with clear hierarchy	Better information recall

ThrottleSync achieved intuitive navigation, voice-first safety, and enhanced group sync — all while maintaining the thrill of independent riding.

SECTION 08

Business Model & Product Growth

ThrottleSync is not just a UX concept — it's a scalable product with clear market viability and a phased growth strategy built around community, safety, and smart technology.

Target Market

Segment	Profile	Pain Point Addressed
Primary	Long-distance tourers & motorcycle clubs	Safety, coordination, hands-free comms
Secondary	Weekend riders & adventure travellers	Distraction reduction, easy group sync
Future	OEM integration (motorcycle manufacturers)	Built-in connectivity & safety ecosystem

Revenue Streams

Model	Description
Freemium	Core features free; smart alerts, analytics & intercom range behind paywall
Subscription	Monthly / annual plans for motorcycle clubs and organised riding groups
Brand Partnerships	Motorcycle OEMs, adventure tourism operators, gear companies
In-App Purchases	Premium map packs, achievement badges, custom UI themes

Growth Roadmap

1	Beta — Small Communities	Launch with touring clubs. Core ride sync + safety features. Gather real-world feedback & validate ecosystem.
2	Scale — Global Expansion	OEM partnerships, expand to international rider networks. Add AI route suggestions & advanced analytics.
3	Ecosystem — Lifestyle Brand	Events, gear integrations, rider social features. ThrottleSync becomes the rider-first lifestyle platform.

Brand Strategy

- ◆ Community First — Rider brotherhood and shared adventure as the emotional core
- ◆ Safety & Reliability — Position as the trusted tech companion for every journey
- ◆ Bold Adventurous Identity — Strong visuals, storytelling, and emotionally resonant UI
- ◆ Partnership & Events — Ride meetups, sponsored tours, and gear collaborations

SECTION 09

Conclusion & Learnings

ThrottleSync is a self-initiated end-to-end UX concept that demonstrates the full design process — from empathy research to strategic product thinking — for a niche, high-stakes user context.

Case Study Summary

Pillar	What Was Solved
Group Coordination	Flexible pace + synced routes + real-time map tracking
Communication	Integrated intercom, music & call management — fully hands-free
Safety & Awareness	Crash / SOS alerts, smart journey reminders, live tracking
Community	Shared summaries, badges, and group trust-building features

Key UX Learnings

Empathy Drives Design	Diverse rider behaviors demanded flexible, non-prescriptive solutions — not one-size-fits-all.
Integration is Key	One coherent dashboard beats four disconnected apps; cognitive load is a safety issue on the road.
Iterative Process Works	Lo-fi → hi-fi → prototype → test cycles caught 5 critical usability issues before launch.
Safety-First UX	Voice prompts and minimal-touch UI are non-negotiable in any high-risk, distraction-sensitive environment.
Storytelling Sells UX	Emotional context and rider lifestyle framing drive adoption and product loyalty.
Community Loyalty	Designing for belonging — not just utility — creates products riders advocate for.

Next Steps

- Expand usability testing with larger and more diverse rider groups
- Polish visual language, add micro-animations and high-fidelity interaction flows
- Explore beta launch with real touring community partners
- Export Behance-ready workflow diagrams and prototype GIFs

"ThrottleSync is more than a design concept — it's a vision for the future of group riding: safe, connected, and fun for every rider, where you ride free, yet never ride alone."